Rajeshwari Majumdar

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Academic Appointments

The George Washington University
Assistant Professor, School of Media and Public Affairs, 2025-

Yale University
Postdoctoral Associate, Identity & Conflict Lab, The MacMillan Center, 2024-2025

Education

New York University
Ph.D., Politics, 2024
Dissertation: *Essays on Religious Nationalism and Partisan Cues in India*
- Winner, Aaron Wildavsky Best Dissertation Award, APSA Religion and Politics Section
- Honorable Mention, Best Dissertation Award, APSA Experimental Research Section

Committee: Gwyneth McClendon (chair), Simon Chauchard, Tara Slough, Joshua A. Tucker

University of Connecticut
B.A., Political Science, 2018
B.A., Economics and Mathematics-Statistics, 2018

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Reducing Prejudice and Support for Religious Nationalism Through Conversations on WhatsApp. Conditionally accepted, *Comparative Political Studies*.
  - Winner of the MPSA Best Paper Award (2024), the MPSA Best Paper in Political Behavior Award (2024), and the APSA Experimental Research Section Best Paper Award (2023)
  - Honorable Mention for the APSA Comparative Politics Section Sage Best Paper Award (2023) and the APSA Religion and Politics Section Weber Best Conference Paper Award (2023)
- Misinformation Beyond Traditional Feeds: Evidence from a WhatsApp Deactivation Experiment in Brazil (with Tiago Ventura, Joshua A. Tucker, and Jonathan Nagler). Forthcoming, *The Journal of Politics*.
  - Winner of the APSA Political Communication Section Paul Lazarsfeld Best Paper Award (2024), the APSA Information Technology & Politics Section Best Paper Award (2024), and the Brazilian Political Science Association Best Paper Award (2024)
- Reaching Across the Political Aisle: Overcoming Challenges in Using Social Media for Recruiting Politically Diverse Respondents (with Maggie Macdonald, Megan A. Brown, Nejla Asimovic, Lena Song, Laura Huber, Sarah Graham, Abby Budiman, Joshua A. Tucker, and Jonathan Nagler). Forthcoming, *International Journal of Social Research Methodology*.

- Partisan Identity, Counter-Attitudinal Information, and Selective Criticism in India. 2024. *Political Behavior* 46(3): 1443–1465.
- Big Data on BHR: Innovative Approaches to Analyzing the Business & Human Rights Resource Centre Database (with Nicole Janz, James Allen-Robertson, and Shareen Hertel). 2021. *Business and Human Rights Journal* 6(1): 120–126.

Working Papers

- Citizen Reactions to Religious Nationalist Rhetoric
- Reducing Social Media Usage During Elections: Evidence from a Multi-Country WhatsApp Experiment (with Tiago Ventura, Shelley Liu, Carolina Torreblanca, and Joshua A. Tucker)
- Perceptions of Group Norms and Conformism in Preferences for Exclusion in India (with Dipin Kaur and Nicholas Sambanis)
- Non-WEIRD Political Ideology: Theory and Evidence from India (with Nicholas Haas)

Book Chapter

- Social Movements, Development Policy, and Human Rights (with Shareen Hertel). 2020. In *Why Human Rights Still Matter in Contemporary World Affairs*. Mahmood Monshipouri (editor). New York: Routledge.

Other Writing

- How Ideology Shapes Indian Politics (with Nicholas Haas). 2023. Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. https://carnegieendowment.org/2023/12/18/how-ideology-shapes-indian-politics-pub-91249
  - Re-printed in *The Hindustan Times* (25 December 2023): https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/how-ideology-shapes-indian-politics-101703440172388.html
- Reducing exposure to misinformation: Evidence from WhatsApp in Brazil (with Tiago Ventura, Joshua A. Tucker, and Jonathan Nagler). 2024. VoxDev. https://voxdev.org/topic/institutions-political-economy/reducing-exposure-misinformation-evidence-whatsapp-brazil

Awards & Fellowships

- APSA Religion and Politics Section Aaron Wildavsky Best Dissertation Award, 2025
- Honorable Mention, APSA Experimental Research Section Best Dissertation Award, 2025
- APSA Political Communication Section Paul Lazarsfeld Best Paper Award, 2024
- APSA Information Technology & Politics Section Best Paper Award, 2024
- Brazilian Political Science Association Best Paper Award, 2024
- MPSA Best Paper Award, 2024
- MPSA Best Paper in Political Behavior Award, 2024
- APSA Experimental Research Section Best Paper Award, 2023
- Honorable Mention, APSA Comparative Politics Section Sage Best Paper Award, 2023
- Honorable Mention, APSA Religion and Politics Section Weber Best Conference Paper Award, 2023

- NYU GSAS Dean's Dissertation Writing Fellowship, 2023-2024
- NYU GSAS Ralph M. Cariello & Ilona Cariello Fellowship, 2018-2023
- NYU GSAS Henry M. MacCracken Fellowship, 2018-2023
- Phi Beta Kappa

Research & Travel Grants

- SPSA Artinian Travel Award, 2026
- APSA Comparative Politics Section Travel Grant, 2025
- APSA Political Psychology Section Distinguished Junior Scholar Award, 2024
- NYU Identities & Ideologies Project Research Grant, 2023
- NSF PolMeth Travel Grant, 2023, 2025
- APSA Travel Grant, 2023
- APSA Religion and Politics Section Small Grant, 2022
- APSA Political Communication Section Travel Grant, 2022, 2023
- APSA EPOVB Section Early Career Fellowship, 2021
- NYU Politics George Downs Grant, 2019, 2021, 2023

Conference & Workshop Presentations

2026: SPSA (scheduled), Brown-Harvard Joint Seminar on South Asian Politics (scheduled), Penn Center for the Advanced Study of India Annual Political Economy Workshop (scheduled)

2025: Yale MacMillan Center Academic Exchange, MPSA, NYU Center for Social Media and Politics Annual Conference, Yale Institution for Social and Policy Studies Workshop, PolMeth, APSA Political Communication Pre-Conference, APSA, MIT Polarization Workshop

2024: MPSA, Penn Center for the Advanced Study of India Annual Political Economy Workshop, APSA

2023: The Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, MPSA, Northeast Workshop in Empirical Political Science (NEWEPS), PolMeth (poster), Social Science Research Council Workshop on the Economics of Social Media, APSA Political Communication Pre-Conference, APSA

2022: MPSA, APSA

2021: Harvard Experimental Political Science Conference, APSA

2020: Winter Experimental Social Science Institute (WESSI), Workshop on the Political Economy of South Asia (WPESA)

Teaching

- The George Washington University
  - Data Analysis (graduate) (Spring 2026)
  - Research Methods (undergraduate) (Fall 2025, Spring 2026)
- New York University (as teaching assistant; all undergraduate)
  - Introduction to Comparative Politics (Fall 2022)
  - Politics Senior Honors I (Fall 2021, Fall 2023)
  - Politics Senior Honors II (Spring 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024)
  - Thinking, Learning, & Consciousness in Humans & Machines (interdisciplinary) (Fall 2020)

Service

- Department
  - GW SMPA Undergraduate Curriculum Committee (2025-2026)
  - NYU Politics Women's Informal Network (2021-2022)
  - NYU Graduate Political Economy Seminar (Spring 2021)
- Discipline
  - Committees: APSA Experimental Research Section Best Paper Award (2024), APSA Information Technology & Politics Section Best Paper Award (2025 chair, 2026), APSA Political Communication Section Best Graduate Student Paper Award (2025), APSA Religion and Politics Section Best Dissertation Award (2026)
  - Conference co-organized: Yale ICL Conference on Intergroup Conflict and Cooperation in India (2026)
  - Conference panels organized: "Religion and Politics in India" (APSA 2022), "What's Up with WhatsApp? Social Media and Politics in the Global South" (APSA 2024), "Intergroup Relations in India" (MPSA 2025)
  - Discussant: APSA ($\times 3$), MPSA ($\times 4$), NEWEPS, DMV-WEPS, Empirical Study of Gender Research Network (EGEN)
  - Reviewer: *British Journal of Political Science*, *Journal of Politics*, *Party Politics*, *Political Behavior*, Quantitative China Studies Seminar

Peer-Reviewed Articles in Other Disciplines

- Majumdar, R. 2020. "On the Effect of a Binary Treatment in the Presence of a Control Covariate." *Calcutta Statistical Association Bulletin* 72(1): 35-42.
- Majumdar, R., P. Mariano, H. Panzo, L. Peng, and A. Sisti. 2020. "Lyapunov Exponent and Variance in the CLT for Products of Random Matrices Related to Random Fibonacci Sequences." *Discrete & Continuous Dynamical Systems - B*.
- Majumdar, R. 2018. "On Least Squares Linear Regression Without Second Moment." *Minnesota Journal of Undergraduate Mathematics* 4(1).
- Majumdar, R. 2017. "Generalization of Pascal's Rule and Leibniz's Rule for Differentiation." *Rose-Hulman Undergraduate Mathematics Journal* 18(1): 201-206.
- Chen, J.P., L. Ford, D. Kielty, R. Majumdar, H. McCain, D. O'Connell, and F. N. Shum. 2017. "Stabilization by Noise of a $\mathbb{C}^2$-Valued Coupled System." *Stochastics and Dynamics* 17(6): #1750046.

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